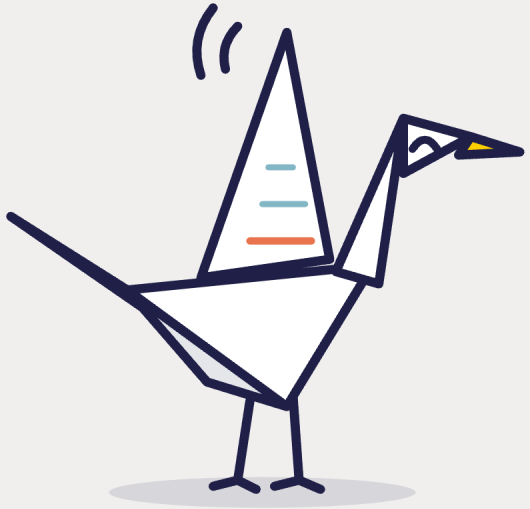
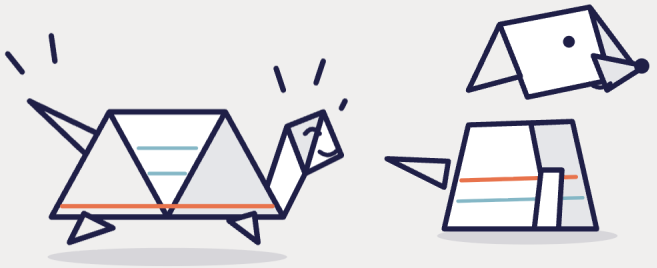
A STORY TOLD IN INDEX CARDS

What I learned building a flashcard app

with Claude

MARK MICHAL
·OCT 2026





WHY I BUILT IT

A problem, then two goals

RAG?

Need a clue?



AI terms kept slipping away between my podcast runs.

GOAL 1

Make something useful

AI terms first, then Bible verses

GOAL 2

Learn how real apps work

Logins, who owns what data, public vs. private

Live at flashcards.crutastic.com

HOW IT GOT BUILT

Three Claudes, one app

STEP 1



Chat

Talk it through and plan it

STEP 2



Code

Build it, then write Design a prompt

STEP 3



Design

Looks, characters and sounds

STEP 4



Code again

Bring the designs in and keep building

Each Claude did the part it's best at.

HOW IT GOT BUILT

The tools around Claude

GitHub
Holds the code and hosts the live site

Supabase
Stores the content and the logins

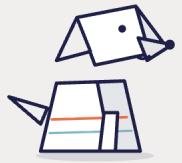
Google Cloud
Powers "Sign in with Google"

Notion
Where the first plan lived

Anthropic API
Lets Wren make cards with AI

GoDaddy
The web address people type in

Claude did the building. Knowing how these pieces connect is the new skill.



UNDER THE HOOD

Where the content really lives

1 · SIGN IN

Sign in with Google

One button. No passwords to manage.

2 · THE APP



Just the front window. It shows what Supabase sends.

3 · SUPABASE

- Decks
- Cards
- Progress (yours only)

Where the content really lives

Everyone studies the same deck. Each person keeps their own progress.

AHA 1

Design does the fun stuff

Paper
Index cards on a desk

Hop Quest
Bunnies, coins and grass

Gem Crew
Jelly gems in a chest

Night Arcade
A glowing 8-bit arcade



One paper bird, seven moods

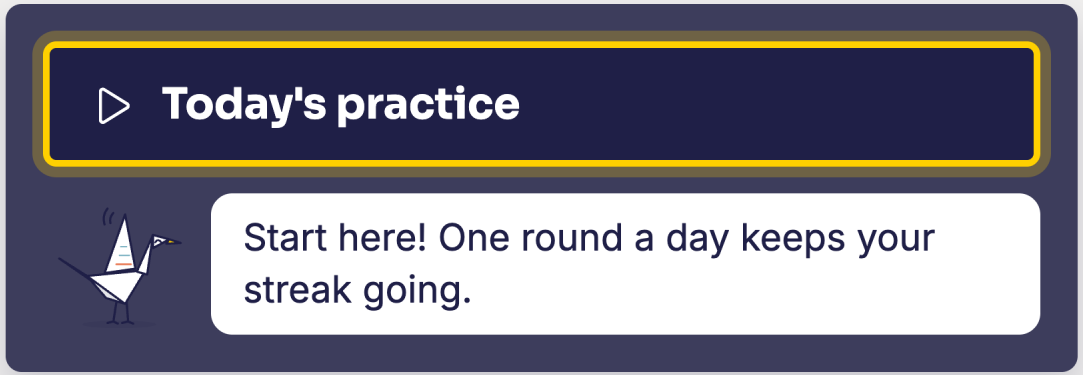
- Card flips, deals and stamps
- A sound set for every theme
- Looking great on the first try

AHA 2

Small features, big payoff

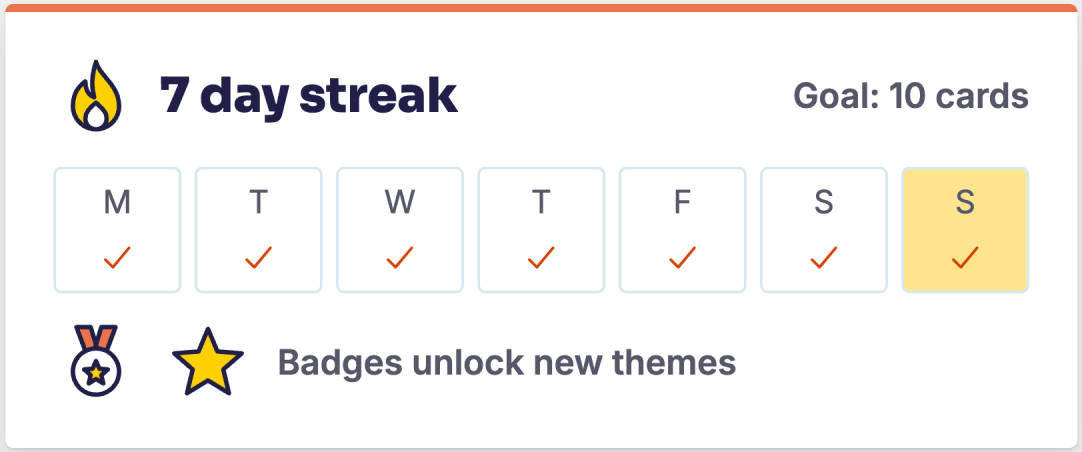
The tour

Easy to build, and it explains the app so we don't have to.



Badges, streaks and goals

Simple to add, and easy to adjust anytime.



AHA 3

Easy ways in, and a window inside

ADMIN

- This week's numbers
- People and permissions
- Daily reminders
- Starter decks

COULD GROW INTO ONE DASHBOARD FOR ALL OUR APPS

Four ways to make a deck

1. **Make it yourself**
   Type the cards in
2. **Import a spreadsheet**
   Drop in a file or paste cells
3. **Use your own AI**
   Copy a prompt into ChatGPT or Claude
4. **Make it with Wren**
   Give a topic or a photo of notes



MY TAKEAWAY

Our limit is shifting from

“What can we build?”

to

“What can we imagine?”

Apps | Websites | Designs

What can you imagine?

